全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 2 單元 | 人物與外貌描述 · People & Descriptions

An Email about the New Kid in Room 302

一封關於302教室新同學的電子郵件

Dear Mei-ling, Thank you for your postcard from Hualien! I have exciting news from Taipei. A newcomer named Ryan joined our class two weeks ago, and he has already changed the atmosphere of Room 302. Ryan is Singaporean, so English is his native language, but his Mandarin is surprisingly good. When our homeroom teacher asked about his nationality, he joked that he was 'half kaya toast, half bubble tea', which made even our strict math teacher laugh.

What I like most about Ryan is his personality. He is sociable without being loud, and he has the kind of youthful energy that makes everyone want to sit near him. He is also modest. Although he is a talented pianist who has performed in concert halls, he never mentions it unless someone asks. Last Friday, when a timid junior student dropped her lunch box in the corridor, Ryan was the first to kneel down and help her clean up. He is thoughtful in a way that few teenage boys are.

Of course, nobody is perfect. Ryan can be stubborn when he believes he is right, and he once argued with our senior class leader for twenty minutes about a rule for the basketball tournament. Some students who had treated him as a rival at first found him unfriendly, but once they got to know him, they became his most loyal supporters. Even the tolerant residents of our dormitory, who have seen plenty of teenage mischief, say he is one of the most mature youngsters they have ever met.

I am honestly a little worried that his reputation as 'the perfect new kid' might put too much pressure on him. Anyway, come and visit soon so you can meet him yourself. Write back when you can! Love, Hsiao-wen

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
newcomer	*n.*	新來的人；新手	The newcomer did not know where the library was. 那位新來的人不知道圖書館在哪裡。

native	*adj.*	本地的；母語的	Her native language is Japanese, but she also speaks Chinese. 她的母語是日語，但她也會說中文。
personality	*n.*	個性；人格	Tom has a warm personality that people like. 湯姆有讓人喜歡的溫暖個性。
sociable	*adj.*	善於交際的	My sister is sociable and makes friends easily. 我姊姊善於交際，很容易交到朋友。
modest	*adj.*	謙虛的	The modest champion thanked her coach instead of herself. 那位謙虛的冠軍感謝的是教練而不是自己。
talented	*adj.*	有才華的	The talented singer wrote all of her own songs. 那位有才華的歌手自己寫了所有的歌。
thoughtful	*adj.*	體貼的；深思的	It was thoughtful of him to bring soup when I was sick. 我生病時他帶湯來，真是體貼。
stubborn	*adj.*	固執的	The stubborn child refused to wear a coat in the snow. 那個固執的孩子在雪中拒絕穿外套。
loyal	*adj.*	忠誠的	A loyal friend stays with you in bad times. 忠誠的朋友在你困難時會陪在你身邊。
reputation	*n.*	名聲	The school has a reputation for excellent teachers. 這所學校以優秀的老師聞名。

片語 Phrases

get to know	認識；逐漸了解	It took me a month to get to know my new classmates. 我花了一個月才認識新同學。
put pressure on	給…壓力	Please do not put too much pressure on the young players. 請不要給年輕球員太大的壓力。
at first	起初	At first I did not like the city, but now I love it. 起初我不喜歡這個城市，但現在我很愛它。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V + without + V-ing

「沒有…地」。without 是介系詞，後面的動詞要改成動名詞 V-ing。

He is sociable without being loud.

他善於交際卻不吵鬧。

Once + S + V, S + V

「一旦…就…」。once 當連接詞用，表示某件事發生後，另一件事就會跟著發生。

Once they got to know him, they became his loyal supporters.

一旦認識他之後，他們就成了他忠實的支持者。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。